Contractor and Consultant Engagement Policy

Policy HR-CT-501 | Version 1.4 | Aurelian Technologies India Private Limited and Aurelian Technologies Inc.

Field	Value
Policy ID	HR-CT-501
Version	1.4
Effective date	1 February 2026
Applies to	Hiring managers, Procurement, HR and all contractors and consultants
Policy owner	Head of Procurement
Approved by	Chief Financial Officer
Next review	31 January 2027
Document status	Active

1. Purpose

This policy governs how Aurelian engages independent contractors, consultants and staff supplied by agencies, and sets out the controls needed to manage cost, legal and misclassification risk.

2. Definitions and Classification

A contractor is an individual or firm providing services to Aurelian under a Master Services Agreement (MSA) and Statement of Work (SOW), invoicing for services rendered, and controlling the manner in which the services are performed. Contractors are not employees of Aurelian. Classification must be reviewed by HR and Legal before engagement, using the classification checklist in Annex A.

3. Engagement Process

- The hiring manager raises a requisition in the procurement system with a draft SOW.
- Procurement verifies the vendor, tax registration (GST in India; W-9 or W-8BEN in the US) and insurance.
- Legal approves the MSA and SOW; Information Security approves system access.
- The contractor signs the Non-Disclosure and IP Assignment Agreement before starting work.

4. Duration

Individual contractor engagements may not exceed 11 months in total without a fresh classification review. Engagements beyond 24 months are not permitted; where the role is ongoing, the hiring manager must open a permanent position.

5. Benefits and Entitlements

Contractors are not eligible for employee benefits. Contractors are compensated only through the fees agreed in the SOW and are responsible for their own taxes, insurance and statutory contributions. Contractors are not enrolled in PeopleHub or Workday and do not accrue any form of leave in Company systems.

5.1 Time away from work

Contractors should agree planned absences with their Aurelian point of contact in advance so that deliverables are not affected. Time not worked is not billable unless the SOW provides otherwise.

6. Remote Work and Location

Contractors may work remotely only where the SOW allows it. Contractors may not perform services from a country other than the one specified in the SOW, and are not eligible for home office or internet allowances.

7. Travel and Expenses

Contractor travel expenses are reimbursable only where the SOW expressly provides for them, and only at or below the limits in the Global Travel and Expense Policy (TR-202). Contractors must submit expenses with their monthly invoice together with original receipts; per diem is not payable to contractors unless the SOW specifies it.

8. Equipment and Access

Contractors receive a Company-managed laptop only where required for access to restricted systems. Access is provisioned with an end date matching the SOW and is revoked on the last day of the engagement.

9. Conversion to Employment

A contractor may be converted to an employee through the standard recruitment process. On conversion, employee benefits begin from the date of joining as an employee; prior contractor service does not count towards service-based eligibility for benefits.

10. Misclassification Risk

Managers must not direct contractors in the same way as employees, set their working hours, include them in performance reviews or give them Company email signatures describing them as employees.

11. Governance, Exceptions and Compliance

11.1 Interpretation

Questions regarding the interpretation of this policy (HR-CT-501) must be raised with the Head of Procurement. Where the wording of this policy is ambiguous, the interpretation issued in writing by the Head of Procurement shall be binding until the policy is next revised.

11.2 Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy require written approval from the relevant Business Unit Head and the Human Resources Business Partner (HRBP). Exceptions are granted on a case-by-case basis, are recorded in the HR case management system, and do not create a precedent for any other employee or case.

11.3 Non-compliance

Misuse of any provision of this policy, including the submission of false or misleading information, may result in recovery of amounts paid, withdrawal of the benefit, and disciplinary action in line with the Code of Conduct and the Disciplinary Procedure described in the Employee Handbook (HR-HB-001).

11.4 Data privacy

Personal data collected in connection with this policy is processed in accordance with the Global Employee Privacy Notice and applicable data protection law, including the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (India) and applicable US state privacy laws. Access is restricted to personnel with a legitimate business need.

11.5 Review

This policy is reviewed at least once every twelve months, or earlier where required by a change in law, business structure or operational practice.

Revision History

Version	Effective	Summary of changes	Approved by
1.0	1 June 2023	Initial release	CFO
1.3	1 January 2025	Maximum tenure 24 months	CFO
1.4	1 February 2026	Clarified benefits exclusion; remote location restriction added	CFO